

Christopher (Chris) Liao
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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

PhD in Economics (Ongoing)

Chancellor's Fellowship

The University of Chicago

Bachelor of Arts in Economics (Data Science Specialization), cum laude with Honors

Dean's List, Financial Markets Program Fellow, David S. Hu Award in Economics

Master of Science in Computer Science

Berkeley, CA

August 2026 — present

Chicago, IL

Conferred, June 2024

Conferred, June 2024

EXPERIENCE

OpenAI

Visiting Economic Researcher

- Study how scientists use OpenAI products to further scientific progress

San Francisco, CA

July 2026 – Present

Harvard Business School

Predocutorial Research Associate (Professor Jesse Shapiro)

- Support research on projects in political economy, econometrics and industrial organization
- Took PhD courses in Econometrics (1st year), Public Economics, and AI + Behavioral Science (2nd year)

Cambridge, MA

July 2024 – June 2026

Citadel

Quantitative Trading Intern (Global Fixed Income)

- Created trading strategies on the US Quantitative Macro and Global Emerging Markets desks

New York City, NY

June 2023 – August 2023

University of Chicago Booth School of Business

Research Assistant (Professors Scott Nelson & Laura Blattner)

- Lead developer on Apache Spark computing cluster for monthly credit report dataset (nationwide, 10% sample)
- Designed and implemented data analytics pipeline for credit report dataset currently used by several research teams
- Trained machine learning algorithms on credit data to simulate credit score algorithms and estimate default risk

Chicago, IL

September 2021 – April 2023

Self-Employed

Research Team Leader (Professors Thomas Sargent and George Hall)

- Research team leader for project on American fiscal history and the national debt in the late eighteenth century
- Created an interactive web app to showcase a granular, individual-level dataset on early American national debt
- Mined Ancestry.com for federal census collection and matched records to our individual-level debt dataset

Remote

June 2021 – August 2024

Rent Butter

Data Science Intern (Professors Scott Nelson & Daniel Waldinger)

- Web scraped tenant applications, leases and ledger records for 40,000 individuals using Puppeteer in JavaScript
- Investigated data issues, anonymized tenant data and used fuzzy string matching to link application and lease tables

Chicago, IL

June 2021 – September 2021

PROJECTS

[Organizational Resilience: Evidence from Open-Source Software](#) (writing sample, ongoing)

[Generalized Random Forest Event Studies](#) (ongoing)

Unravelling Hierarchical Structure in Open-Source Software (awarded the David S. Hu Award in Economics)

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Oeconomica (UChicago's Economics Undergraduate Research Society)

President

- Organize events such as research seminars, career opportunity events, the BFI panel and the Econometrics Game

Chicago, IL

September 2020 – June 2024

SKILLS

Languages: English, Chinese (Mandarin), Spanish

Computer Languages: R, Python, SQL, JavaScript, Java, C, Ruby, DrRacket, Octave, Git, TeX, Bash, Go, Scratch

Awards: FDIC Challenge Finalist, 2021 UChicago Econometrics Game 2nd place, Published in The Concord Review

Interests: Running, Poker, Instant film, Board games